

Academy for Extraordinary Witches



est. 2024

2024 Official Club Documents

a·cad·e·my

/uh-kad-uh-mee/ noun

an organization intended to protect and develop an art, science, language, etc.

The word academy comes from the Greek word Akademeia, the name of the park or grove outside of ancient Athens where Plato taught Philosophy.

The site of the Academy was sacred to Athena; it had sheltered her religious cult since the Bronze Age. Among the religious observances that took place at the Akademeia was a torchlit night race from altars within the city to Prometheus' altar in the Akademeia.

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Coven Council

Head Witch:

Tonya Brown

Role: To organize, plan, and execute a successful member event. To keep in mind the spirituality, safety, magical growth, and personal support of each member. To make tough decisions for the greater good of all the members and the society at large. To uphold the legacy of AFEW for many years to come.

Coven Keeper:

Kiki Dombrowski

Role: To help organize, plan, and execute a successful member event. To facilitate classes, rituals, and events in a way that best supports each member. To be a role model and bar for which we all reach for in terms of kindness and integrity. To uphold the legacy of AFEW for many years to come.

Academy Bylaws

- I. **Kindness/Ego** – Being a member of AFEW and being part of this academy requires us all to leave our egos at the door. This is not an opportunity to be the *biggest witch in town*, nor is it a time to make others feel small. In our culture, which is very individualized and greedy, kindness and support is radical. Be radical. Be kind. It's punk as hell.
- II. **Support/Panhels** – I believe we all come into this spirituality partly in hopes of finding others like us. Maybe over time we're disappointed over and over again and eventually we think we need no community. This club is meant to challenge that belief. Many will come to our yearly events after heartbreaks, difficult years, and life-altering events. Let's do our best to be pillars of support when we can, so that when the day comes that we cannot hold ourselves up, we have each other.
- III. **Participation** –
 - a. We do not require participants in all events. If you are not interested in a class or activity you are welcome to go enjoy yourself elsewhere. That being said, when you are participating with the academy, please be a productive part of the experience. Acting as if we know it all, are bored, or otherwise uninterested not only undermines those teaching but makes those learning feel inadequate. We are catering to members of varying levels, with the goal of raising all our magical skill together. Also, behavior like this goes against Articles I & II.
 - b. If you find you would like to teach a class during the yearly member event, please reach out to the Head Witch with your class pitch. Those who teach will receive a \$100 reimbursement of their membership dues.
- IV. **Membership Dues** -

- a. On time – we ask that members send in their membership dues on time according to the following schedule.
 - i. Member Renewal Deposit: February 15th. (20 day grace period)
 - ii. New Member Deposit: March 15th (7 day grace period)
 - iii. Member Second Payment: June 1st (7 day grace period)
 - iv. Member Third Payment: September 1st (7 day grace period)
 - v. Member Final Payment: December 1st (7 day grace period)
 - b. Cancellation - Any member can cancel their membership and withdraw from the academy by June 1st in order to receive a deposit refund. After this date, no refund can be made.
 - c. Inflation – Due to inflation, membership dues may go up each year. Renewing members will be grandfathered in at their original year's rate. If they switch room types, they will pay their original year's rate for that room type. If a member cancels their membership but then returns at a later time, they will no longer be grandfathered in and will pay the new member rates.
 - d. Teaching – a member can pitch a class to the Head Witch and if they teach during an event, they will receive a \$200 reimbursement for their membership dues.
- V. **Member Gift** – Each year members will receive a unique and custom gift upon arrival that cements and establishes them as a member of this amazing academy.
- VI. **Grimoire** –
- a. The society's grimoire is an amazing way in which old members can share their knowledge and magic with new members. The 2024 founding class will be the one to establish the grimoire. At the beginning of the event, every club member will be given a page of the grimoire to share their go-to/favorite/most vital spell. At the end of the event we will come together to reassemble the grimoire.

- b. The grimoire will be in the possession of the Head Witch during non-event times, and during the event any member will have access to look through and gain knowledge from the grimoire.
 - c. Each class will have the opportunity to vote on the next legacy item that will be purchased for the club.
- VII. **House Rules** – Each venue we use for our events will come with a separate set of house rules, and we are expected to follow them closely. Members will be given house rules upon arrival.
- VIII. **Conflicts** – Conflicts among members shouldn't happen the one time a year we see each other, however, we're all human and personality conflicts can happen. If you find yourself at odds with another member of the club, please come to the Head Witch or Coven Keeper to share what is going on. We will do our best to resolve the issue in a way that keeps everyone's privacy and dignity intact and prevents the souring of the event.
- IX. **Personal Support** – the AFEW website has a member area that contains a forum/community enter. Use it all year to connect with each other, and form supportive relationships. Also, if you are going through a hard personal time, feel free to reach out to us. We're here for you. That's partially what the society is all about.
- X. **Scholarship** – Each year we estimate the budget we'll need to run a successful event. Our goal each year is that we come under budget. Any overage of membership dues of the prior year will be set aside and used for potential hardship scholarships. If a legacy member (a non-new member) of AFEW finds themselves in a difficult financial situation, they can apply for the overage to go towards their future dues.

Goals for 2024

- Establish a founding class and set the bar for expectations.
- To run a successful event and learn how to better improve the following years.
- To establish an AFEW go-to ritual style.
- To establish the official AFEW grimoire.